THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

Revision Notes

Class 8 · Social Science

Exploring Society: India and Beyond — Part 2, Chapters 8 to 15 · CBSE / RBSE Syllabus

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Each chapter follows the textbook's own order of sections, so you can read straight through. Bold words are keywords you must be able to define. Tables compare and classify; shaded boxes hold definitions, formulas and key facts. The navy Key Takeaways box at the end of every chapter is your last-two-minutes revision.

CH.	CHAPTER TITLE	CORE THEME
8	World Geography: Some Glimpses	Maps, oceans, continents, landforms and human impact on the environment
9	India’s Long Road to Independence	Reforms, Congress, Swadeshi, revolutionaries, Gandhian movements, World War II, Partition and independence
10	A Journey Through Indian Architecture	Harappan town planning, stupas, rock-cut caves, water structures, temples, mosques, forts, tombs, houses, churches and colonial buildings
11	The Role of the Judiciary in Our Society	Justice, structure of the courts, Supreme Court and High Court powers, PIL, tribunals, digital courts and alternate dispute resolution
12	Citizenship: Rights and Duties	Citizenship, Fundamental Rights, Fundamental Duties, discrimination and inclusion
13	Dynamics of Population	Demography, fertility and mortality, migration, demographic transition, population pyramids and the demographic dividend
14	India's Urban Landscape	Urban and rural areas, density, growth of cities, urban challenges, planned cities
15	Cultural Currents: 13th to 17th Centuries	Bhakti and Sufi, music, painting, women, education, science, literature, food and clothing 13th–17th c.

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CHAPTER 08 · GEOGRAPHY (PART 2)

World Geography: Some Glimpses

A quick tour of our blue planet: how maps show the round Earth on flat paper, what lies in the oceans, and the mountains, plateaus, plains and deserts of each continent. Along the way we see how human actions disturb these natural features.

Big Questions

- What are the unique physical features of the continents?
- Why do we need to understand world geography?
- How do human actions trigger environmental issues?

Mapping the Earth

The Earth is an **oblate spheroid**: nearly spherical, bulging at the equator and flattened at the poles. Drawing it on a flat map therefore always causes some **distortion** (think of laying a peeled orange flat). A **cartographer** is a person who draws or produces maps.

Colour on a physical map	Shows
Blue	Water bodies: oceans, seas, lakes, rivers
Green	Plains
Yellow / brown	Plateaus
Dark brown	High mountains
Light yellow	Deserts
White	Ice and glaciers

Projection	What it does well	Limitation
Mercator	Keeps shape and direction, so useful for navigation	Distorts size near the poles (Greenland looks as big as Africa)
Robinson	Compromise between size and shape distortion; looks realistic	Still not perfect

NOTE

Professionals use **latitude and longitude** coordinates for precise locations, because every flat map projection is only approximate.

The Blue of the Blue Planet: The Oceans

- Oceans cover about **71 per cent** of the Earth's surface and hold **97 per cent** of its water; hence the name 'blue planet'.
- They absorb and slowly release heat and add moisture to the air, so they help **regulate climate** and bring rainfall.

- Plankton (tiny organisms that float and make food by photosynthesis) give us almost **half the oxygen** we breathe.
- The ocean floor has mountains, valleys and plains like the land.

Ocean	Key features
Pacific	Largest and deepest; whales and tuna
Atlantic	One of the busiest waterways for trade; rich fishing ground
Indian	Warm waters, rich biodiversity, historically important for trade
Arctic	Smallest and shallowest; sea ice; polar bears and walruses
Southern	Encircles Antarctica; penguins and seals

▸ Currents, trenches and reefs

- **Ocean currents** are giant river-like flows. **Warm currents** carry water from the equator to the poles; **cold currents** carry it from the poles towards the equator.
- The **Gulf Stream** carries warm water towards Western Europe, making the United Kingdom warmer than other places at the same latitude.
- **Trenches** are deep V-shaped areas. The **Mariana Trench** is deepest; its Challenger Deep is over 11,000 m below sea level, more than 2,000 m deeper than Everest is high. With no light, life there uses **energy from chemicals**.
- A **reef** is a ridge at or near the sea surface. Coral reefs are the **'rainforests of the sea'**: they shelter about one-quarter of all ocean species.
- The **Great Barrier Reef** (north-east Australia) is about 2,000 km long, covers about 350,000 sq km and is a UNESCO World Heritage Site. **Coral bleaching** (caused largely by human actions changing ocean chemistry) kills coral and destroys habitat.

▸ Smaller water bodies

Type	Meaning	Example
Sea	Large, partly enclosed saltwater area connected to an ocean	Arabian Sea
Gulf	Large inlet of the sea cutting deeply into land	Persian Gulf
Bay	Smaller, broad inlet of the sea	Bay of Bengal
Strait	Narrow channel joining two seas or oceans	Strait of Malacca
Canal	Man-made channel connecting water bodies	Suez Canal

The **Suez Canal** (opened 1869) joins the Red Sea and the Mediterranean and is the shortest sea route from India to Europe. The **Bay of Bengal** is the world's largest bay; bays give ports safe shelter from strong winds.

The Continents: Variety on Land

There are seven continents: Africa, Antarctica, Asia, Australia, Europe, North America and South America. Four landforms recur: **mountains** (high, broad base, steep slopes, narrow summit), **plateaus** (raised, flat top, steep sides), **plains** (extensive flat or gently rolling land) and **deserts** (less than 25 cm rain a year).

▸ Asia

- **Tibetan Plateau:** highest and largest plateau; about 2,500 km by 1,000 km, average height over 4,500 m. Formed by the collision of the Indo-Australian and Eurasian plates. It is the 'Third Pole' (largest fresh-water store outside the poles) and the source of the **Indus, Brahmaputra and Yangtze**.
- **Gobi Desert** (Mongolia and north China): 'Land of the Eternal Blue Sky' with 8–9 months of sun, winters down to minus 30°C; herders move seasonally.
- **Eurasian Steppes:** flat, unforested grassland over 8,000 km; a **carbon sink**; resting place of the Siberian crane; nomads live in yurts.
- **Ural Mountains:** about 2,500 km long; boundary between Europe and Asia; taiga forests, tundra and **permafrost** (frozen soil that releases greenhouse gases when it melts); rich in iron ore, copper, coal, oil and gas.

> **DEFINITION**
>
> **Water towers:** mountains are called water towers because snow and glaciers on them melt to supply fresh water to rivers.

▸ Europe

- **Great European Plain:** fertile, with wheat, barley, rye and potatoes; rivers help trade; supports cities like Paris, Berlin, Moscow, Warsaw.
- **Alps:** crescent-shaped, about 1,200 km; Mont Blanc; edelweiss (national flower of Austria); feed the Rhine and Danube; tourism and hydropower.

▸ Africa

- **Sahara:** largest hot desert; rainfall under 25 cm; oases, date palms, nomads with camels; adaptations such as the fennec fox's large ears and cacti storing water.
- **Savannah:** tropical grassland between rainforest and desert; elephants, lions, zebras, giraffes; threatened by farming and deforestation.
- **Nile:** longest river (about 6,650 km); cradle of ancient Egyptian civilisation; gives irrigation, water, fish, power and transport.

▸ South America

- **Andes:** largest mountain range of the continent; Aconcagua (highest in the Western Hemisphere); Uyuni (largest salt flat); source of the Amazon; copper, zinc, silver, lithium. Only about one-fourth of the original flora and fauna remains: a **conservation hotspot**.
- **Amazon:** world's largest river by volume; the rainforest is the 'Lungs of the Earth'; about 400 indigenous communities; threatened by deforestation.
- **Atacama Desert** (Chile): about 1,000 km, one of the driest places; clear skies; now a dump for discarded **fast-fashion** clothes.

▸ North America and Australia

- **Colorado Plateau:** over 330,000 sq km, Grand Canyon cut in layers of rock by erosion; about 5 million visitors a year.
- **Rockies** (about 4,800 km) hold copper, gold and silver; Yellowstone shows ecosystem restoration: wolves introduced in 1995 reduced overgrazing elk.
- **Appalachians:** among the oldest ranges; coal, timber, gas. **Great Lakes:** five large fresh-water lakes used for shipping and drinking water.
- **Australia:** much of it is desert (Great Australian Desert, Great Victoria Desert); the Spinifex people have lived there for over 25,000 years.

- **Antarctica** is the largest desert on Earth (over 14 million sq km) and the coldest.

Humans and the Environment

- Landforms shape **climate, settlement, farming and trade**.
- Human actions such as **deforestation, overuse of resources and pollution** cause desertification, biodiversity loss and climate change.
- Studying world geography helps us manage resources wisely for **sustainable development**.

Likely question	Model answer
Why does every flat map distort the Earth?	Because the Earth is a nearly spherical oblate spheroid; flattening it stretches size, shape or direction.
Why is the Tibetan Plateau called the Third Pole?	It holds the largest fresh-water reserves outside the polar regions.
Why are coral reefs called the rainforests of the sea?	They shelter about one-quarter of ocean species and are rich in biodiversity.
What made the Great Lakes and the Nile important?	Both supply water and transport; the Nile gave Egypt its civilisation.
How did wolves restore Yellowstone?	They reduced the overgrazing elk, so plants returned.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Every flat map distorts the round Earth; Mercator keeps shape and direction, Robinson is a compromise.
- Oceans cover 71% of the Earth, hold 97% of its water, supply oxygen and regulate climate.
- Each continent has signature landforms: Tibetan Plateau, Gobi, Urals, Alps, Sahara, Nile, Andes, Amazon, Rockies, Great Barrier Reef.
- Human actions threaten these features; sustainable use is the answer.

CHAPTER 09 · HISTORY (PART 2)

India’s Long Road to Independence

From the Crown’s takeover in 1858 to freedom in 1947, people of many regions, faiths and views challenged the British Empire. They differed in methods (petition, boycott, satyagraha, revolution) but shared the goal of Swaraj.

Big Questions

- How did a diverse land come together to end nearly two centuries of British rule?
- What were the main developments and who were the important figures?
- What did the leaders agree or disagree on?

British Rule after 1858

- In **1858** the Crown (Queen Victoria) took over from the East India Company. The **Viceroy** governed in India; the **Secretary of State** in London.
- The proclamation promised to respect about **560 princely states** (under British ‘paramountcy’) and not to impose Christianity; in practice a **Resident** watched each state.
- Heavy land taxes, famines and cheap British goods hurt peasants and local industry.
- Indians were treated as inferior: lower pay, biased juries, segregated clubs and trains. The **Arms Act (1878)** and **Vernacular Press Act (1878)** controlled arms and the Indian-language press.

Reform Movements and Cultural Currents

Movement	Leader, year	Main ideas
Brahmo Samaj	Raja Ram Mohan Roy, 1828, Calcutta	Against child marriage and caste bias; for widow rights and girls’ education; English education
Arya Samaj	Swami Dayananda Saraswati, 1875, Bombay	Return to the Vedas; reason, equality, self-reliance; women’s education and widow remarriage
Other reformers	Vidyasagar, Syed Ahmad Khan, Jyotirao and Savitribai Phule	Modern education, especially for girls and the marginalised; fight caste and gender inequality

- **Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay** wrote *Anandamath* (1882) containing the song **Bande Mataram** (composed 1875); Tagore set it to music in 1896; it became the **National Song** in 1950.
- **Swami Vivekananda** (born Narendranath Datta, 1863) spoke at the 1893 Chicago Parliament of Religions, founded the Ramakrishna Mission and urged: “Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached.” His birthday, 12 January, is National Youth Day.

Rise of the Congress and Growing Discontent

- The **Indian National Congress** was founded in **1885** at Bombay (A.O. Hume, Dadabhai Naoroji, W.C. Bonnerjee as first president; 72 delegates). It began by asking for small reforms in a loyal tone; the government largely ignored it.
- **Kuka (Namdhari) movement** (Baba Ram Singh, Punjab): hand-spun white clothes, boycott of foreign goods, own post and courts; suppressed and Ram Singh exiled to Burma.

- **Poona plague of 1896:** harsh measures led the Chapekar brothers to shoot the Plague Commissioner.
- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** ('Lokmanya'): newspaper *Kesari*, Ganesh and Shivaji festivals; jailed for sedition; wrote *Gita Rahasya*.
- **Birsa Munda:** tribal prophet of Chota Nagpur; led the **Ulgulaan (Great Tumult)** in 1899–1900; died in jail aged 24.

Partition of Bengal and the Swadeshi Movement (1905)

- **Lord Curzon** divided Bengal in 1905 on the pretext of administration; it was 'divide and rule' between the Muslim east and Hindu west.
- People tied **rakhis** for unity, sang Vande Mataram, and joined processions led by Tagore, Surendranath Banerjee, Bipin Chandra Pal and others.
- **Swadeshi** (use Indian goods) and **boycott** (reject foreign goods, schools, courts) spread; bonfires of foreign cloth were lit.
- Examples of Swadeshi enterprise: Tata's Swadeshi Mills (1886), Punjab National Bank (1895), Bengal Chemicals (P.C. Ray, 1901).
- **1906:** *Bande Mataram* daily (Bipin Pal, Aurobindo); **Bengal National College** (Aurobindo first principal); Calcutta Congress under Naoroji declared **Swaraj, Swadeshi, Boycott and National Education**.
- The Partition was annulled in **1911** and the capital moved from Calcutta to Delhi.

▸ Muslim League and the Surat Split

- **All-India Muslim League** founded at **Dhaka, December 1906**, to protect Muslim political interests.
- **Surat, 1907:** the **Moderates** (Naoroji, Gokhale, Mehta, S. Banerjee) wanted gradual reform; the **Nationalists** (Tilak, Lajpat Rai, Aurobindo) wanted self-rule. The Congress split.

The Revolutionaries

Year	Event
1902	Anushilan Samiti founded in Bengal
1904	Abhinav Bharat (Savarkar) founded
1908	Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki attack Judge Kingsford's carriage; Alipore Bomb Case; Aurobindo acquitted
1909	Bombs at Viceroy Minto's carriage; Nashik magistrate shot
1912	Bomb thrown at Viceroy Hardinge in Delhi
1914–15	Ghadar Movement tries to start a mutiny in the army
1915	Bagha Jatin dies after the Balasore gunbattle (German Plot)

- The **Cellular Jail** (Andamans), '**Kala Pani**', held revolutionaries in solitary confinement and forced labour.
- **Rash Behari Bose** escaped to Japan and later helped lay the foundation of the INA.

Home Rule and the Lucknow Pact (1916)

Tilak and **Annie Besant** launched the **Home Rule Movement** for self-government within the Empire. At Lucknow the Congress and Muslim League signed a pact; the Congress accepted **separate electorates** for

Muslims.

Gandhi and Mass Movements

- **Gandhi** (born Porbandar, 1869) developed **satyagraha** (insistence on truth, based on ahimsa) in South Africa; returned in 1915 and led local struggles: Champaran (indigo), Ahmedabad (mill workers), Kheda (peasants).
- **Vallabhbhai Patel** led the Bardoli movement (1928) and was called **Sardar**.
- **Rowlatt Act (1919):** detention without trial. **Jallianwala Bagh, 13 April 1919:** Dyer fired for about ten minutes on a Baisakhi crowd; Tagore returned his knighthood.
- **Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22)** with the **Khilafat Movement** (Ali brothers, Azad): boycott of foreign goods, schools and courts; **khadi** as a symbol. Withdrawn after **Chauri Chaura** (Feb 1922).
- **Simon Commission (1927):** no Indian member; 'Simon Go Back'; Lala Lajpat Rai died after a lathi charge (1928).

▸ Revolutionaries of the 1920s–30s

- **Kakori train robbery (1925)** by HRA (Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Chandrashekhar Azad); Bismil and Khan were executed.
- **Bhagat Singh** (HSRA): Assembly bombs 'to make the deaf hear'; hanged in 1931 with Rajguru and Sukhdev.
- Women such as **Bina Das** and the schoolgirls Suniti Chowdhury and Shanti Ghosh also took up arms.

Purna Swaraj and Civil Disobedience

1928 — Nehru Report
Motilal Nehru's report asked for dominion status.

1929 — Lahore session
Congress demanded **Purna Swaraj** (complete independence).

1930 — Salt March
Gandhi walked about 380 km to **Dandi** and broke the salt law; civil disobedience spread; many women joined.

1930 — Qissa Khwani Bazaar
Peshawar firing; Garhwali soldiers refused to fire.

1931 — Gandhi–Irwin Pact
Prisoners released; Congress joined the Round Table Conference.

1934 — Withdrawal
Movement ended; Government of India Act 1935 gave provincial autonomy.

IMPORTANT

Poona Pact: Ambedkar sought separate electorates for the Depressed Classes; Gandhi fasted against this; the compromise gave **more reserved seats** instead.

Separate Nations and World War II

- **Iqbal** (1930, League session at Allahabad) proposed a separate Muslim territory in the north-west; Jinnah later backed the idea of Pakistan; most Congress leaders, including Azad and Abdul Ghaffar Khan, opposed it.

- In **World War II** over 2.5 million Indians served; shortages and the **Bengal famine of 1943** brought great suffering.
- **Subhas Chandra Bose** escaped in 1941, reached Germany, then Singapore (1943), formed the **Indian National Army** and the Azad Hind government; the INA fought in Burma and north-east India and was defeated.
- **Cripps Mission (1942)** offered dominion status after the war with provincial opt-out; rejected.
- **Quit India (August 1942):** Gandhi's call '**Do or Die**'; leaders arrested, mass protests; Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted the flag at Gowalia Tank; Kanaklata Barua (17) was martyred.

Partition and Independence

- 1946: mutinies in the Royal Indian Air Force and Navy; **Cabinet Mission** failed; **Direct Action Day** (16 Aug) led to Calcutta riots; Nehru's Interim Government.
- **Mountbatten** chose **Cyril Radcliffe**, who had five weeks to draw the **Radcliffe Line** splitting Punjab and Bengal.
- Partition caused mass migration and violence; **independence on 15 August 1947**; Nehru became Prime Minister.
- **Sardar Patel**, the 'Iron Man of India', integrated the 560 princely states by persuasion and, rarely, force.

Approach	Who	Method
Moderates	Naoroji, Gokhale, Mehta	Petitions and gradual reform
Nationalists	Tilak, Lajpat Rai, Pal, Aurobindo	Swaraj, Swadeshi, boycott, national education
Revolutionaries	Khudiram, Bhagat Singh, Bagha Jatin	Armed action
Gandhian	Gandhi, Patel, Nehru	Satyagraha, non-violence, mass movements
Military	Subhas Bose	INA fought alongside Axis forces

Likely question	Model answer
Why was Bengal partitioned in 1905 and how did people respond?	Curzon claimed administration, but it divided Hindus and Muslims; people launched Swadeshi, boycott and rakhi unity.
What was the Surat split?	In 1907 the Moderates and Nationalists parted ways.
Why did Gandhi withdraw Non-Cooperation?	Violence at Chauri Chaura broke non-violence.
What did the Lahore Congress of 1929 demand?	Purna Swaraj, complete independence.
Why did Britain leave India?	Mass movements, revolutionaries, INA and mutinies, plus a weakened post-war Britain and decolonisation.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- After 1858 the Crown ruled India; reformers, the Congress and later the Nationalists challenged British rule.
- Bengal's partition (1905) launched Swadeshi and boycott; the Surat split (1907) divided Moderates and Nationalists.
- Gandhi turned the struggle into mass movements: Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India; revolutionaries and the INA pursued armed paths.
- Independence on 15 August 1947 came with Partition's violence and displacement; Patel united the princely states.

CHAPTER 10 · HISTORY/CULTURE (PART 2)

A Journey Through Indian Architecture

Architecture is the art and technique of design and construction, joining use with beauty. This chapter takes a journey through representative Indian structures, from Harappan cities to colonial buildings, and shows the ideas, materials and skills behind them.

Big Questions

- What role has architecture played in Indian civilisation?
- What key concepts and developments lie behind Indian architecture?
- Why does this heritage matter today?

The Beginnings: Harappan Architecture

- The earliest known tradition of **urban planning** in the subcontinent: planned cities, drainage, water management and civic organisation.
- Most cities used **bricks**, as they lay in alluvial plains where clay is plentiful.
- **Mohenjo-daro** (Sindh): wide streets and narrow lanes, almost every home had a bathing area, used water left through drains.
- **Dholavira** (Rann of Kachchh): used **stone**, had a fortified **Castle** area, a sentinel room at the gate and large reservoirs.
- Harappan **wells** used trapezoid-shaped bricks that lock together, so the walls did not collapse inward.
- Larger houses had a **central courtyard**, a design still used 4,500 years later.

Stupas and Rock-Cut Caves

Type	Key points	Examples
Stupa	Dome-shaped, holds relics of the Buddha or monks; railings (vedika) and gateways (toranas); Buddha shown through symbols such as footprints and the wheel of dharma	Sanchi (Ashoka, Madhya Pradesh), Bharhut (donor inscriptions)
Rock-cut caves	Carved into rock for worship, residence or assembly; durable and efficient	Udayagiri–Khandagiri (Odisha, 2nd century BCE, Jain monks, Kharavela inscription); Ajanta and Ellora (Maharashtra)

DEFINITION

Pradakshina means walking around a sacred structure in a clockwise direction. It began at stupas and continued in later temples.

- **Kailasha Temple, Ellora** is a monolithic temple: thousands of tonnes of rock were chipped away to leave it standing.
- **Ellora cave 10** has an arched roof copying timber beams, a seated Buddha leaning on a stupa, and an aisle for pradakshina.

▸ **Don't miss out**

- **Sharada Peetha** (Kashmir): famed centre of learning, linked to the Sharada script, flourished 6th–12th centuries; now in ruins.
- **Hidimba Devi Temple** (Manali): 16th century, dedicated to Hidimba from the Mahabharata.
- **Jageshwar group** (Uttarakhand): about 124 stone temples.
- **Golden Temple** (Punjab): Sikhs' holiest shrine, begun by Guru Ramdas, continued by Guru Arjan Dev in 1588.

Water Structures

- India's monsoon climate led to many ways of **harvesting, storing and sharing water**, from village ponds to grand works.
- **Shringaverpur** (Uttar Pradesh): linked reservoirs filled by a Ganga channel in flood season; early tanks let silt settle.
- **Stepwells (vavs or baoris)** of Gujarat and Rajasthan: **Rani ki Vav** has pillared levels and hundreds of statues; they also gave a cool meeting place.
- **Pushkarinis** are temple reservoirs for water harvesting and rituals, e.g. at Vijayanagara.
- Many are threatened today by pollution, waste and poor upkeep.

Classical Temple Architecture

Classical temples began in the **Gupta era** and followed the rules of **shilpashastra** (treatises on arts and crafts). Temples were centres of worship, learning, art and economic life.

Part	Meaning
Gopuram / torana	Ceremonial entrance
Mandapa	Pillared hall
Garbhagriha	Innermost chamber with the deity's image, facing east
Shikhara / vimana	Tower above the garbhagriha (north / south India)
Prakara	Enclosure wall of a large complex

IMPORTANT

A temple is planned as the body of **Purusha**, the cosmic being: the tower is the head and the platform the feet. Worship is a journey from the outer world to the inner shrine.

Temple	Place and date	Features
Brihadishvara	Thanjavur, built by Rajaraja Chola I around 1010	Vimana over 60 m, big mandapas, Nandi from one stone, granite carvings
Lingaraja	Bhubaneswar, early 11th century	Shiva shrine, three mandapas, sandstone and laterite, ornate carvings
Dilwara	Mount Abu, 11th–13th centuries, Solanki dynasty	Five Jain temples in white marble, carved on every surface
Bishnupur	West Bengal, 17th–18th centuries	Brick temples with terracotta panels of Radha, Krishna, Rama and daily life

From the 10th century temples grew into vast complexes. Their planning needed advanced geometry, as with Egypt's pyramids and Europe's Gothic cathedrals. None of these structures used cement mortar.

Mosques, Forts and Palaces

- **Mosque**: prayer hall facing Mecca, domes, minarets, mihrab; large ones are called **Jama Masjid**.
- **Jama Masjid, Ahmedabad** (Ahmed Shah I, 15th century): yellow sandstone, jalis and temple-style pillars; shows **Indo-Islamic** blending with local Hindu and Jain artisans.
- **Jama Masjid, Delhi** (Shah Jahan, mid-17th century): India's largest mosque, red sandstone and white marble, two 40 m minarets, courtyard for 25,000 people.
- **Mehrangarh Fort** (Jodhpur): red sandstone from the mid-15th century; palace now a museum; Jaswant Thada is a cenotaph.
- **Agra Fort**: rebuilt by Akbar in red sandstone from Dholpur; Shah Jahan added marble palaces; fountains cooled it.
- **Orchha**: Bundela Rajput complex on the Betwa with Jahangir Mahal (Rajput–Mughal blend).
- **Mysuru Palace**: Indo-Saracenic, early 20th century, golden throne displayed at Dasara.

> **NOTE**
> A **cenotaph** remembers a person but is not a tomb, since the body is cremated elsewhere.

Tombs, Houses, Churches and Colonial Buildings

- **Humayun's Tomb** (Delhi, 1558): commissioned by Bega Begum, Persian architects; symmetry, gardens, six-pointed star.
- **Taj Mahal**: Shah Jahan's tomb for Mumtaz Mahal; Persian charbagh garden, Arabic calligraphy and Indian chhatris and lotus designs; inlay of semi-precious stones.
- **Havelis** of Shekhawati (Rajasthan): central courtyard, frescoes; many now hotels or museums.
- **Chettinadu houses** (Tamil Nadu): merchant homes using Burmese teak and Italian marble; courtyards for rituals and drying papads.
- **Churches** in Kerala mix local styles, e.g. the stambha at Mulanthuruthy and the tiled roof at Kalloopara.
- **Indo-Saracenic** (British Raj): blends Islamic, Hindu and Gothic elements, as in the Madras High Court and Victoria Memorial.

Exam Corner

Likely question	Model answer
Why did Harappans use brick in most cities?	They lived on alluvial plains where clay is plentiful.
What is a stupa?	A dome-shaped structure holding relics of the Buddha or revered monks.
Why are stepwells important?	They stored rainwater and gave a cool social space.
What is the garbhagriha?	The innermost temple chamber housing the deity's image.
What is Indo-Saracenic architecture?	A British Raj style blending Islamic, Hindu and Gothic elements.
What do the Fundamental Duties say about heritage?	Citizens must value and preserve our rich composite culture.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Harappan cities were the earliest planned towns, using brick and, at Dholavira, stone.
- Stupas and rock-cut caves grew with Buddhism and Jainism; pradakshina continued into temples.
- Water structures such as stepwells and pushkarinis show Indian skill in water harvesting.
- Classical temples have set parts and symbolise the cosmic being; styles differ by region.
- Indo-Islamic and colonial buildings blend different traditions.
- Protecting heritage is a duty of every citizen.

CHAPTER 11 · CIVICS (PART 2)

The Role of the Judiciary in Our Society

Justice keeps a society peaceful and fair. This chapter explains the link between law and justice, the court system of India, the powers of the Supreme Court and High Courts, and quicker ways of settling disputes outside the courtroom.

Big Questions

- What is the concept of justice?
- Why is it important for a just and harmonious society?
- What is the structure and role of the judiciary in India?
- What are the alternate modes of dispute resolution?

Law and Justice

- The Preamble promises **social, economic and political justice**.
- The judiciary is one of the three pillars of government and is **independent** of the legislature and executive.
- **Laws** are general rules made by government; breaking them can bring a fine, compensation or imprisonment.
- Over **1500** colonial laws were repealed, such as the **Criminal Tribes Act, 1871** and the **Vernacular Press Act, 1878**.
- Unjust laws elsewhere: **Jim Crow laws** in the USA (repealed 1960s) and **apartheid** in South Africa (repealed 1991).

	Substantive justice	Procedural justice
Focus	Final outcome	Process before the decision
Question	Is the decision fair and reasonable?	Did everyone get a full hearing?

IMPORTANT

Everyone is presumed **innocent until proved guilty**.

Structure of the Judicial System

India has a **unified** system: **Supreme Court** (apex), **High Courts** (state level) and **Subordinate Courts** (district level).

▸ Supreme Court of India

Point	Detail
Established	26 January 1950, Article 124; seat New Delhi
Role	Final interpreter of the Constitution
Strength	Chief Justice of India plus 33 judges

Point	Detail
Appointment	By the President
Qualification	Citizen, plus High Court judge 5 years, or advocate 10 years, or distinguished jurist
Retirement	65 years
Motto	Yato dharmastato jayah: where there is dharma, there is victory

Jurisdiction	What it covers
Writ (Art. 32)	Enforcing Fundamental Rights
Original (Art. 131)	Centre–State and inter-state disputes
Appellate (Arts. 132–134A)	Appeals from High Courts and tribunals such as NGT
Advisory (Art. 143)	Opinion for the President, bench of at least 5 judges
Special Leave (Art. 136)	Discretionary appeal in matters of public importance

- **Article 141**: law declared by the Supreme Court binds all courts.
- **Article 142**: orders needed for complete justice.
- **PIL** (public interest litigation) addresses public concerns; first case by **Kapila Hingorani** for about 40,000 under-trial prisoners.
- Other PILs: **M. C. Mehta** (Ganga, Taj Mahal), **Vishaka** (1997 guidelines; 2013 Act).

▸ High Courts and Subordinate Courts

- Article 214: a High Court in each state; **25 High Courts** serve 28 states, some shared with Union Territories.
- Judges are appointed by the **President** after consulting the CJI, the Governor and the High Court Chief Justice; they retire at **62**.
- Writ jurisdiction (Art. 226) and **superintendence** over lower courts (Art. 227).
- **District Judges** are appointed by the Governor with the High Court (Art. 233).
- Subordinate courts include District, Sessions, Revenue and Small Causes Courts.

▸ Tribunals

Tribunal	Decides
NCLT	Company and insolvency disputes
APTEL	Electricity disputes
NGT	Environmental issues
Armed Forces Tribunal	Armed forces matters
Central Administrative Tribunal	Service matters of government employees
Consumer fora	Consumer disputes

Modern Reforms

- New criminal laws (2023): **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita** replaces IPC 1860; **Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** replaces CrPC 1973; **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam** replaces the Evidence Act 1872.
- Digital courts: **e-Filing, hybrid hearings, live streaming**, translated judgments, **National Judicial Data Grid**, Virtual Justice Clock.

Alternate Dispute Resolution

Mode	Key idea	Law
Arbitration	Independent arbitrator gives a final, binding decision	Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996
Mediation	Neutral mediator helps settle; cannot impose a decision	Mediation Act, 2023
Lok Adalat	People's court settling cases amicably	Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987
Gram Nyayalaya	Mobile village courts with simple procedure	Gram Nyayalayas Act, 2008

Exam Corner

Likely question	Model answer
Differentiate substantive and procedural justice.	Substantive concerns a fair outcome; procedural concerns a fair hearing and process.
Which Articles allow writ petitions?	Article 32 for the Supreme Court and Article 226 for High Courts.
What is PIL?	A petition addressing a public concern, introduced by the Supreme Court.
Who appoints Supreme Court judges?	The President of India.
Name two ADR methods.	Arbitration and mediation (also Lok Adalats).
What is a tribunal?	A specialised body deciding a certain type of dispute.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The judiciary is an independent pillar that ensures justice and keeps laws within the Constitution.
- Justice has substantive and procedural sides.
- India has a three-tier court hierarchy headed by the Supreme Court.
- The Supreme Court has writ, original, appellate and advisory powers; PILs widened access to justice.
- Tribunals and ADR methods reduce the burden on courts.
- Digital initiatives make courts more open and accessible.

CHAPTER 12 · CIVICS (PART 2)

Citizenship: Rights and Duties

Standing up for a classmate who is teased, building a ramp for a friend in a wheelchair, keeping a colony clean: these are everyday acts of citizenship. This chapter explains who a citizen is, which rights the Constitution guarantees, which duties we owe in return, and how to resist discrimination and build an inclusive society.

Big Questions

- What does it mean to be a citizen, not just legally but in everyday life?
- Why are both rights and duties essential?
- How can we build a society where everyone is treated fairly, respected and included?

Who Is a Citizen?

DEFINITION

A **citizen** is a person who legally belongs to a country and is a member of its political community, so can take part in its decision-making. Citizenship is both a **legal identity** and a **social responsibility**.

	Resident	Citizen
Meaning	Lives in a place	Formal legal member of the country
Rights	Not all rights of a citizen	Rights and duties under the Constitution
Example	A foreigner working in India	An Indian who lives abroad is still an Indian citizen

- Citizens enjoy rights such as voting, free speech and living and working safely, but these rights have **limits**.
- They also have duties: obeying the law, paying taxes, respecting others and helping keep society safe.
- All citizens are **equal under the Constitution**; the rules for gaining or losing citizenship come from the **Citizenship Act, 1955** and the **Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019**.

The chapter studies four ideas: **rights, duties, discrimination** and **inclusion**. Inclusion is the positive way of ensuring non-discrimination.

Rights

DEFINITION

Rights are justified claims that we need to live with dignity, safety and respect, such as education, livelihood and free expression. Actions that harm ourselves or others cannot be called rights.

▸ The six Fundamental Rights

Fundamental Right	Articles	What it protects
Right to equality	14–18	Equality before law; no discrimination; equal opportunity in public jobs; end of untouchability and titles (except military and academic)

Fundamental Right	Articles	What it protects
Right to freedom	19–22	Speech, movement, peaceful assembly; life and personal liberty; education (21A)
Right against exploitation	23–24	Bans trafficking, forced labour and child labour
Right to freedom of religion	25–28	Practise, profess and manage religion; no forced religion
Cultural and educational rights	29–30	Language, script and culture; minority institutions
Right to constitutional remedies	32	Approach the Supreme Court if rights are violated

IMPORTANT

Fundamental Rights protect people from unfair treatment by others **and** from unfair actions of the government. They are **enforceable by courts**.

▸ Equality and equity

- **Equality** gives everyone the same support; **equity** gives each person the support they need, because historical inequality makes people start differently.
- Example: the **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao** campaign raises awareness and supports girls' education.
- Ramps for wheelchairs and braille books are equity measures.

▸ Freedom, life and dignity

- The **right to freedom** covers speech, movement and peaceful assembly, but with **reasonable restrictions** so freedoms are not misused.
- The **right to life** means living with dignity: livelihood, education, health, a clean environment and fair treatment. It also protects children with disabilities.
- **Rights of nature:** New Zealand treats the Whanganui River as a living being and Costa Rica protects Nature's rights. In 2017 the Uttarakhand High Court gave the Ganga and Yamuna legal status, but the Supreme Court overturned it as legally unsustainable.

▸ Exploitation, religion, culture and remedies

- **Exploitation** means taking unfair advantage of others: bonded labour, human trafficking, abuse and child labour. Children below **14** may not be employed in factories, mines or hazardous work; they may help in family work after school or in vacations.
- **Childline 1098** is the national helpline for children (remember: count backwards from 10). In 2015 a call led to the rescue of 20 children from a clothes-embroidery factory.
- The **right to freedom of religion** lets everyone choose, practise and share their religion; no one is forced to follow or fund one, and government schools cannot promote a religion.
- **Cultural and educational rights**: communities can protect language and traditions; no student can be refused admission on grounds of religion, caste, race or language; minorities can run their own schools.
- **Right to constitutional remedies** (Article 32): Dr B. R. Ambedkar called it the *soul and heart* of the Constitution because rights would otherwise be only promises on paper.

Duties

DEFINITION

Fundamental Duties are responsibilities of citizens listed in **Article 51A (Part IV-A)**. They remind us that being a citizen is not only enjoying rights but also contributing to the nation.

- The original Constitution (1950) had no duties. **10 duties were added in 1976** by an amendment.
- The **11th duty** was added in **2002**: parents or guardians must ensure education for children aged **6 to 14**.

Duty (summary)	Example from the chapter
Respect the Constitution, Flag and Anthem	Standing silently during the anthem
Follow the ideals of the freedom struggle	Speaking up against bullying
Protect India's unity, integrity and sovereignty	Friends learning each other's languages
Defend the nation and help in emergencies	NCC cadets in a flood
Promote harmony and respect women	Stopping students who tease a girl
Preserve culture and heritage	Not writing on a fort wall
Protect the environment and show compassion to animals	Planting trees; water bowls for strays
Develop scientific temper	Teaching basic water filtering
Protect public property and avoid violence	Not breaking benches after a defeat
Strive for excellence	Waste segregation in school
Ensure education for children aged 6–14	Persuading a father to send his daughter to school

NOTE

Ancient ideas: **dharma** (duty and what benefits society), **ṛiṇa** (debts to gods, ancestors, teachers, fellow humans and Nature) and **adhikāra** (capacity or authority, later meaning rights).

Rights and Duties: Two Sides of the Same Coin

	Rights	Duties
Nature	Freedoms and benefits every citizen enjoys	Responsibilities towards others
Enforcement	Protected by law; courts can enforce	Moral and social; not always legally punished
Purpose	Live with dignity	Use freedom wisely and respectfully

- Every right has a matching duty: the right to respect brings the duty to respect others; the right to express opinions brings the duty to listen.
- Right to education matches the parents' duty to educate and the student's duty to learn.

Discrimination

DEFINITION

Discrimination is unfair treatment of a person or group because of caste, religion, ethnicity, disability, race, appearance, gender, sexuality or economic background. It is unethical and legally prohibited.

- It harms the person psychologically and physically and also society; it creates barriers that stop people from enjoying Fundamental Rights.
- **Visible**: teasing Rohan for his weight. **Invisible**: ignoring Mina because her family could not afford a trip. Invisible discrimination is hard to prove and so hard to punish.
- **Savitribai Phule** opened a school for girls in the mid-19th century despite abuse; **Anandibai Joshi**, married at nine in 1874, became a doctor against social opposition.

Inclusion

DEFINITION

Inclusion means creating an environment where everyone feels welcomed, respected and valued, with equal access to opportunities, especially groups historically excluded.

- It goes beyond reservations: language support, welcoming all castes and religions, braille books, ramps and classroom help.
- Example: Smt. Amita's reading club added regional-language books so that all children joined.
- Students can include others by waiting, explaining patiently and giving everyone a chance to speak.

Likely question	Model answer
Who is a citizen?	A person who legally belongs to a country and can take part in its decision-making.
How many categories of Fundamental Rights are there?	Six, from equality to constitutional remedies.
Difference between equality and equity?	Equality gives the same support; equity gives support according to need.
Which article protects children's free and compulsory education?	Article 21A, for ages 6 to 14.
When were Fundamental Duties added?	In 1976; the 11th duty was added in 2002.
Why is Article 32 important?	It lets citizens go to the Supreme Court to enforce their rights.
Why are rights and duties linked?	Each right requires others to be respected, so rights come with matching duties.
What is invisible discrimination?	Indirect unfair treatment such as exclusion or jibes; it is hard to prove.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- A citizen has **legal membership** of a country, with **rights and duties**.
- The Constitution gives **six Fundamental Rights**, enforceable through courts (Article 32).
- **Fundamental Duties (Article 51A)** were added in 1976; the 11th in 2002.
- **Rights and duties** go together: use freedom wisely and respect others.
- **Discrimination** violates the Constitution; **inclusion** removes barriers and makes everyone feel welcome.
- Everyday actions such as speaking up, following the law and including others build a peaceful society.

CHAPTER 13 · GEOGRAPHY (PART 2)

Dynamics of Population

How many people live in the world, how many are young or old, and why do these numbers change? This chapter introduces demography and shows how births, deaths and migration shape the population of India and the world, and how age structure affects the economy.

Big Questions

- What is demography?
- What are some important concepts of demography?
- How has the population of India and the world changed over time?
- How do population trends shape societies and economies?

What Is Demography?

DEFINITION

Demography is the study of the human population: its **size, structure and composition, pattern and trend**, and how it changes over time through births, deaths and migration.

- Governments use it to plan schools, hospitals, roads, housing, water and energy. Many children mean more schools; more elderly people mean more healthcare; many young workers mean more jobs are needed.
- Businesses study age, gender and income to design products.
- The **census** is the official count of people, generally done in India every **10 years**, collecting data on age, sex, marital status, education, languages, religion, occupation and income.

NOTE

Working-age population is the group generally aged 15 to 64 who are most productive. **Structure of population** means how people are divided by age, gender, education and so on.

Population at a Glance

Fact	Figure
India overtook China as most populous country	2023
India's share of world population	About 17%
World population 1950 → 2025	2.5 billion → 8.2 billion
Expected in 2050	9.7 billion
Projected peak	10.3 billion in the mid-2080s
Asia and Africa (2025)	4.8 billion and 1.5 billion

Year	India's population (million)
1951	361
1961	439
1971	548
1981	683
1991	846
2001	1,020
2011	1,210
2025	1,460

- Rapid growth after 1950 came from antibiotics, vaccines, oral rehydration solution, better water and sanitation and fewer child deaths.
- China, Japan and Italy already have shrinking populations; Nigeria and Ethiopia are growing rapidly.

What Determines a Country's Population?

Indicator	Meaning
Birth rate	Live births per 1,000 population in a year
Fertility rate	Average number of children a woman has in her lifetime
Death (mortality) rate	Deaths per 1,000 people in a year
Migration	Movement of people from one place to another to settle temporarily or permanently

FORMULA

Replacement level fertility = 2.1. Above 2.1 the population tends to grow; below 2.1 it tends to shrink. Natural increase per 1,000 = **birth rate − death rate**. Example: 20 − 8 = 12 per 1,000.

▸ Falling fertility

- **China**: One-Child Policy (1979) cut fertility from 7.5 in 1963 to 1 in 2025; population peaked at 1.43 billion in 2022 and has begun to shrink; elderly share to rise from 14% (2023) to 26% (2050). The policy ended in 2015 and up to three children are now allowed.
- **India**: 'Hum do humare do' campaign from 1952; fertility fell from **5.7 (1950) to 1.9 (2025)**.
- Reasons: girls' education, women's jobs and later marriage, urbanisation and high cost of living.

State/UT	Fertility rate	Female literacy (%)
Bihar	3.0	55
Uttar Pradesh	2.4	66.1
Jharkhand	2.3	61.7
Karnataka	1.7	73.4
Punjab	1.6	79.4

State/UT	Fertility rate	Female literacy (%)
Delhi	1.6	83.7

IMPORTANT

The table shows that where **female literacy is higher, fertility is lower**.

▸ Mortality and migration

- Child mortality in India fell from **271 per 1,000 (1950) to 28 (2023)**; life expectancy rose from about **30 years to 70 years (2024)**.
- **Life expectancy** is the average number of years a newborn is expected to live under present conditions.
- People migrate for jobs and education (pull) or because of disasters and instability (push). Cities like Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru grew through migration, which strains water, land, housing and transport.

Demographic Transition

Stage 1 — High birth, high death
Population growth is slow. India in 1901–1921.

Stage 2 — Death rate falls, birth rate high
Rapid growth. India after 1951.

Stage 3 — Death rate low, birth rate falls
Growth slows; may shrink as in Italy, Japan and South Korea. India after the mid-1980s.

India’s Population: Composition and Trends

- **Sex ratio** = number of **females per 1,000 males**. India: 933 (2001) → 943 (2011); women were 48.5% of the population. Kerala, Puducherry and Tamil Nadu are near or above 1,000.
- Uttar Pradesh has the largest share of India’s population (about 16%).
- **Population pyramid**: a graph of age groups by gender. A wide base means a young, growing population; a wide middle means a stable working population; a wide top means an ageing population.

Pyramid shape	What it shows	Example
Wide base, narrow top	High births, short life	India in 1950; Nigeria
Bell-shaped	Fewer births, large working-age group	India recently
Wide top	Ageing population	Japan

Demographic Dividend and Ageing

DEFINITION

Demographic dividend is the economic growth potential from a large working-age population. A large young population (16–30) is called a **youth bulge**.

Country	Median age (years)
India	28
China	40

Country	Median age (years)
USA	39
Germany	47
Italy	48
Japan	50

- About **27%** of Indians are under 15 and nearly **65%** are of working age (15–59); the rest are older.
- India's under-5 population peaked in **2007** and under-15 in **2011**; after **2050** India will begin to age, so the window is limited.
- Kerala and Tamil Nadu are ageing faster than Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.
- Ageing means more healthcare needs, fewer workers and pension pressure. Japan raised the retirement age and uses technology and robots.
- Developing countries must invest in education, skills and health, and support women who face a **double burden** of job and household work with childcare and flexible hours.

Likely question	Model answer
What is demography?	Study of the size, structure and change of human population.
Why is 2.1 called replacement level?	It is the average number of children needed to replace the parents.
Define sex ratio.	Number of females per 1,000 males; India had 943 in 2011.
Name the stages of demographic transition.	High birth and death rates; falling death rate with high birth rate; low death rate with falling birth rate.
What is the demographic dividend?	Growth potential from a large working-age population.
Why is India's dividend temporary?	The young population will begin to decline after 2050.
How do female literacy and fertility relate?	Higher female literacy goes with lower fertility.
State India's increase in population from 2001 to 2011.	1,210 − 1,020 = 190 million.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Demography** studies population size, structure and change.
- Population changes through **births, deaths and migration**; replacement fertility is **2.1**.
- India's fertility fell from 5.7 to 1.9, and life expectancy rose to about 70 years.
- Countries pass through **three stages** of demographic transition.
- The **pyramid shape** reveals whether a population is young, stable or ageing.
- India's **demographic dividend** is a limited window; education, skills and health are the way to use it.

CHAPTER 14 · GEOGRAPHY (PART 2)

India's Urban Landscape

From Harappan Dholavira to today's Mumbai and Bengaluru, cities have been centres of trade, ideas and culture. This chapter explains how cities grow, what problems they face, and how good planning in places like Jaipur and Singapore can make them liveable.

Big Questions

- How do cities become centres of diverse economic activities?
- In what ways can urbanisation affect people's lives?
- What challenges do cities face in the 21st century?
- How can effective urban planning improve life in cities?

Urban and Rural Areas

	Urban area	Rural area
Population	Large, concentrated, dense	Smaller, close-knit
Occupations	Business, industry, services, government jobs	Mostly agriculture-based
Governance	Elected local bodies (municipal)	Gram panchayat
Transport and communication	Elaborate networks, metro, highways	Less elaborate

IMPORTANT

Definitions differ across countries: a place is urban if its population exceeds **220** in Denmark, **50,000** in Japan and **5,000** in India.

▸ Population density

FORMULA

Population density = total population ÷ area (sq km), measured as persons per sq km. Example: 1,20,000 people in 40 sq km = 3,000 per sq km. Experts who study this are **demographers**.

By 2050 about **68 per cent** of the world will live in cities (55 per cent now). India's urban share rose from **17 per cent (1951)** to about **40 per cent (2025)**.

How Cities Become Economic Centres

Cities grew near **rivers**, at **trade crossroads**, and near **farm produce and raw materials**. This helped markets and artisans, and cities became centres of economic and political power.

DEFINITION

Urbanisation is the shift of population from rural to urban areas, with a fall in the share of people living in rural areas.

Rural origin

Farm-related work.

Early urbanisation
Factories, banks, hotels and institutions appear; secondary and tertiary jobs grow.

Small towns
Trading centres attract people and diverse jobs.

Metropolis
High-rises, malls, metro networks and a large population.

City	Reason for growth
Jamshedpur (Sakchi)	Near iron ore; Asia's first steel plant; planned Tata township; renamed in **1919**; largest industrial city of Jharkhand
Mumbai	Arabian Sea port; **Bombay Stock Exchange (1875)**; film industry from 1910s; financial capital
Kolkata	Port near the eastern coast; capital of British India; Durga Puja (UNESCO 2021)
Bengaluru	'Silicon Valley of India': software firms, start-ups, higher education, AI
Hyderabad	Technology-based enterprises
Delhi and NCR	Capital, administration, universities; NOIDA and Ghaziabad; Gurugram IT and **BPO** hub since the 1990s
Agra, Amritsar, Varanasi	Tourism and pilgrims; transport, hospitality, handicrafts

▸ Specialised towns

- **Moradabad**: brass work
- **Ludhiana and Tirupur**: textiles
- **Jaipur**: handicrafts and gem jewellery
- **Channapatna**: wooden toys
- **Kanchipuram**: silk sarees
- **Kochi, Indore, Lucknow, Nagpur**: lower operating costs, so firms set up offices and warehouses

DEFINITION

BPO (Business Process Outsourcing): a company hires another provider to do some business functions, reducing cost and bringing expertise.

Cities as Cultural Hubs

- People from many regions share food, languages and festivals: **vaḍā pāv** in Mumbai's mills.
- Kolkata's **Durga Puja** is on UNESCO's list of Intangible Cultural Heritage (2021).
- Cities build museums (Indian Museum, **Pradhanmantri Sangrahalay**), libraries, stadiums and venues for networking.

Challenges Faced by Cities

Challenge	Detail
Air pollution	NCR often records **AQI above 400**; safe limit is **50**

Challenge	Detail
Water scarcity and flooding	Overuse of groundwater, no rainwater harvesting, lakes encroached
Traffic and unplanned roads	Narrow roads, growing number of vehicles
Heat islands	Concrete and loss of green cover raise temperature
Waste	More garbage and poor management
Slums	Overcrowded settlements with poor housing and services, near the periphery, railway tracks, industrial areas
Crime	Higher density and inequality

NOTE

Slum dwellers do **informal work** (vending, domestic help, laundry, construction, plumbing). The **Pradhan Mantri Aawaas Yojana** gives affordable housing to economically weaker households.

▸ Case: reviving Bengaluru's lakes

Bengaluru once had about **1,000 lakes**; rapid urbanisation cut them to about **200**, many polluted. Bellandur and Varthur had foam and even fires. NGOs, Resident Welfare Associations and communities now revive lakes by **desilting, repairing bunds, clearing drains, planting native species and restocking fish**.

Planning Our Cities

DEFINITION

An **urban planner** designs how land is used in cities to improve infrastructure and quality of life. A **Master Plan** is a long-term document guiding growth.

	Jaipur	Singapore
Planner and date	Vidyadhar Bhattacharya for Sawai Jai Singh II, **1727**	Concept Plan for 40 years; Master Plan updated every **5 years**
Layout	Grid of rectangular **chowkris**; nine public squares; vāstu and śhilpa shāstra	Mixed-use areas: homes, offices, parks close together
Features	Wide streets, gardens, 20-foot wall, **seven gates**, **pink sandstone**, shaded markets, reservoirs	MRT, cycling and walking paths, vertical and rooftop gardens ('garden city'), housing for seniors with healthcare
Density	Planned for the dry climate	Over **8,000 persons per sq km** yet high quality of life

- **Sabarmati Riverfront (Ahmedabad)**: promenades, parks, markets, boating, Atal Bridge.
- **M.G. Road, Gangtok**: pedestrian-only, clean and lively.
- **ICT** tools: intelligent traffic systems, online grievance platforms, solar-powered public spaces.

Quick Revision: Likely Exam Questions

Likely question	Model answer
Define urbanisation.	Shift of population from rural to urban areas.
How is population density calculated?	Total population divided by area in sq km.
Why was Jamshedpur set up at Sakchi?	Near iron ore for Asia's first steel plant.
Why is Mumbai the financial capital?	Port location and the Bombay Stock Exchange set up in 1875.
Name three urban problems.	Air pollution, slums, water scarcity and traffic.
Why is Jaipur called the Pink City?	Buildings on major streets were made of pink sandstone.
Why is Singapore a model of planning?	Long-term Concept Plan, flexible Master Plan, mixed-use land, public transport and green buildings.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Cities are centres of **economic, cultural and administrative** activity.
- Location, resources, industry, tourism and good infrastructure drive growth.
- Rapid growth brings **pollution, slums, traffic, water scarcity and heat islands**.
- Good **planning** (Jaipur, Singapore, Sabarmati) and community action (Bengaluru lakes) make cities sustainable.

CHAPTER 15 · HISTORY/CULTURE (PART 2)

Cultural Currents: 13th to 17th Centuries

Between the 13th and 17th centuries politics was unstable, yet Indian culture grew richer. Saints sang of unity, musicians and painters blended styles, scholars translated texts, and craftspeople kept skills alive. This chapter shows how India adopted and adapted without losing its core.

Big Questions

- How did Indian culture endure and grow despite invasions and instability?
- What were the major cultural trends and movements?
- How did different cultural currents interact and mingle?

Culture and Common Patterns

DEFINITION

Culture is the shared way of life of a group, passed down generations: values, customs, art, music, literature, philosophy and science.

- India welcomed visitors from ancient times (e.g. Greek scholar **Megasthenes**, 4th century BCE) and adopted or adapted the best of external influences.
- Three patterns in this period: **continuation** of traditions, **patronage** by rulers of varied backgrounds, and **participation** of all sections of society.

Belief Systems: Bhakti and Sufism

DEFINITION

Bhakti mārga is the path of devotion to god, one of several paths to **mokṣha**; it needs no rituals or priests and had crystallised by the 6th century.

Saint	Region / period	Message
Kabir	Uttar Pradesh, 15th c.; weaver family	One god; criticised rituals of Hinduism and Islam
Ravidas	Early 16th c.; leather-workers' family	Equality and oneness; broke varṇa and jāti barriers
Guru Nanak	Travelled widely	One God, equality; hymns in the **Guru Granth Sāhib**
Mirabai	Rajasthan	Devotion to Krishna
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	East (Bengal)	Kirtan, devotion to Krishna
Tukaram, Dnyaneshwar, Namdev	West (Maharashtra)	Devotional abhangs in Marathi
Purandaradasa, Kanakadasa	South	Devotional compositions; Purandaradasa is the **father of Carnatic music**

Saint	Region / period	Message
Ālvārs and Nāyanārs	Tamil Nadu, 6th–9th c.	Divya Prabandham (Viṣhṇu), Tiruvāchakam (Śhiva)

> **NOTE**
> Kabir's doha *kābā phir kāsī bhayā, Ram bhayā re Rahīm* says that, like wheat ground into flour, all differences vanish when the divine is realised.

▸ Sufism

- A path of Islam stressing **devotion and an inner personal search** for god.
- **Qawwālī** songs fused Indian, Persian and Arabic styles; saints: **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti, Nizamuddin Auliya**; **Amir Khusro** is credited with qawwālī.
- Used meditation and **zikr** (repeated chanting of divine names); the whirling dervish is a form of meditation.
- Bhakti and Sufi traditions overlapped; **Dara Shikoh** translated **52 Upaniṣhads** into Persian.

Music and Dance

- Nāṭyaśhāstra shaped dance, drama and music; storytelling traditions include Rajasthani puppetry and **paṭṭachitra** (Odisha, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh).
- Two streams: **Hindustani** (north) and **Carnatic** (south, largely unaffected by Persian influence).
- **Dhrupad** flourished under Raja Mansingh Tomar of Gwalior (late 15th c.); **Tansen** joined **Akbar's** court as one of the nine ratnas.
- Modern **sitar** and **tabla** evolved in these centuries from older instruments such as the pakhāwaj.

Painting and Gardens

	Rajput painting	Mughal miniature
Period	15th to late 19th century	Reached its height under Akbar
Themes	Hindu themes: lotus, banyan, elephants, peacocks	Secular: portraits, court scenes, landscapes
Influence	Traditional Indian	Persian
Examples	Holi scene from Bikaner; Rāmāyaṇa scenes	Razmnama (Persian Mahābhārata); Jahangir-nama by Abu al-Hasan

Paper reached India in the 10th or 11th century, moving painting from walls to paper. Styles mixed: Mughal court painters who moved to Bikaner blended both. The Mughal **charbagh** (four parts with waterways, terraces and fountains) is seen at **Nishat Bagh, Srinagar**, Amer Fort and Rashtrapati Bhawan.

Women in Society

- After invasions, **purdah** and **ghūnghaṭ** became more common, mainly in north India; public life of women declined.
- **Razia Sultan** (13th c.), first and only woman ruler of the Delhi Sultanate; led armies, opened schools; opposed by nobles.
- **Nur Jahan** (early 17th c.): issued orders, coins in her name, patron of art and trade.

- In the **south**, elite women stayed in administration; temple donations; **Tirumalamba** wrote *Varadambika Parinaya*.

Education and Knowledge

- Gurukulas, maṭhas, temple schools, vihāras, jain pallis, **pāṭhaśhālās**, madrasās; **Kanchipuram** and **Sringeri** for advanced study.
- **Nālandā and Vikramaśhilā** destroyed in the late 12th century, but local systems and guild apprenticeships continued.
- Pietro Della Valle (1623) saw schools teaching reading, writing and arithmetic in Karnataka.

Craft	Details
Banarasi brocade	Gujarat weavers moved to Banaras under Akbar; zarī and brocade; **GI tag**; vegetable dyes being promoted
Pashmina	Soft wool from Ladakh and Kashmir goats; Persian būtā (paisley) motif; patronised by Mughals

Literature, Language and Science

- Persian became the language of administration; Sanskrit works such as **Līlāvatī** (by Faizi) and **Rājataraṅgiṇī** were translated into Persian.
- Bengali literature grew under Chaitanya's influence; **Kavindra Paramesvara** translated the Mahābhārata into Bengali.
- **Urdu** grew from Hindavi in the Ganga–Yamuna plains; **Amir Khusrau** is called its father; Dakhini in the Deccan.
- Science: pure **zinc** distillation; **Narayana Pandita's Gaṇitakaumudī**; **Madhava** of the **Kerala School**: infinite series, π, calculus; **Nilakantha Somayaji** (1500) planetary model before Copernicus (1543); **saltpetre**, **Itr Jahangir**; Ayurveda, Siddha, Unani.

Architecture, Food and Clothing

- **Konark** Sūrya Mandir (13th c., Eastern Ganga, 24 wheels); **Ranakpur** Jain temple (15th c., Dhanna Seth); **Sheesh Mahal**, Amer Fort (Raja Man Singh I); Hampi under **Krishnadevaraya**; **Srirangam** temple rebuilt after damage.
- Food: spices, curd marination, ghee; **naan**, **samosa** (from sambūseh) and **jalebi** (from zalabiyeh).
- Clothing: **jama**, **pyjama**, dupatta, **angrakha**; muslin and silk output increased.

Quick Revision: Likely Exam Questions

Likely question	Model answer
What is the bhakti mārga?	The path of devotion to god that needs no rituals or priests.
Who is the father of Carnatic music?	Purandaradasa.
What is qawwālī?	Sufi devotional song fusing Indian, Persian and Arabic styles.
Who translated 52 Upaniṣhads into Persian?	Dara Shikoh.
What is a charbagh?	A Persian garden with four parts, waterways and terraces.

Likely question	Model answer
Name the first woman ruler of the Delhi Sultanate.	Razia Sultan.
Who worked out the planetary model in 1500?	Nilakantha Somayaji of the Kerala School.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Culture continued to grow through **continuity, patronage and participation**.
- **Bhakti and Sufi** movements promoted equality, devotion and unity.
- Music, painting, language and food show **adaptation and mixing** (Hindustani and Carnatic, Rajput and Mughal, Urdu).
- Decentralised education, the Kerala School and rebuilt temples show **cultural resilience**.